PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | SIEM, EDR and Incident Response Specialist

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience securing complex enterprise environments. I specialise in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) operations, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), and security gateway management across hybrid infrastructure. At the University of the Arts London (UAL), I lead the detection engineering and incident response function, operating across CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint across an estate of 8,000 users. I have a strong track record in remediating penetration test findings, managing email and web security gateways including Mimecast, and enforcing identity controls through Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory). I bring a methodical, hands-on approach to improving an organisation's security posture and am comfortable owning threat detection, alert triage, incident response and security awareness delivery in a small, high-performing team.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and SOAR:** CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Microsoft Sentinel, Kusto Query Language (KQL), SOAR automation and playbook development, Splunk Security Platform Language (SPL)
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent (EDR), CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, CrowdStrike Falcon Discover, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)
- **Email and Web Security Gateways:** Mimecast Email Security, web proxy management, anti-phishing and anti-spoofing controls
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID, Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck; penetration test finding remediation and tracking
- **Firewall and Network Security:** Check Point Harmony Firewall; experience reviewing and implementing firewall policy changes
- **Threat Intelligence and Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), NIST 800-61 Incident Response, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting, SOAR automation, Microsoft Intune and Mobile Device Management (MDM)
- **Security Awareness:** Security awareness programme design and delivery, phishing simulation campaign management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

University of the Arts London (UAL)

- Lead SIEM and EDR operations across CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, performing daily alert triage, threat hunting and detection rule development aligned to MITRE ATT&CK for an 8,000-user estate
- Manage the full incident response lifecycle (identification, containment, eradication, recovery and post-incident review) in line with NIST 800-61, coordinating with infrastructure and application teams to minimise dwell time
- Administer Mimecast email security gateway, configuring anti-phishing, anti-spoofing and sandboxing policies; investigate and respond to email-based threats escalated through the security operations queue
- Oversee Entra ID Conditional Access policies, MFA enforcement and Privileged Identity Management (PIM) to reduce identity-based attack surface and enforce least-privilege access
- Track and remediate penetration test findings from internal and third-party assessments, prioritising remediation using risk-based scoring and reporting progress to the IT Security Officer

- Conduct vulnerability management using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS, producing actionable remediation reports for infrastructure and development teams
- Design and deliver security awareness training and phishing simulation campaigns to improve end-user security behaviours across the institution
- Develop and maintain SOAR automation playbooks and PowerShell scripts to reduce mean time to respond (MTTR) on high-volume, low-complexity alerts

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

University of the Arts London (UAL)

- Performed day-to-day alert triage, investigation and response across the SIEM and EDR platforms, escalating confirmed incidents and maintaining detailed investigation records
- Supported the deployment and ongoing management of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender across the 8,000-user estate
- Administered BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to enforce privileged account governance and reduce lateral movement risk
- Assisted in Cyber Essentials Plus certification by conducting gap assessments and implementing remediation actions across endpoint, network and identity controls
- Managed Microsoft Intune for Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) across iOS and Android endpoints
- Supported Check Point Harmony firewall administration, reviewing change requests and implementing security policy updates
- Contributed to CrowdStrike Falcon platform rollout, configuring detection policies, exclusions and response actions in line with the organisation's risk appetite

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech)

- Provided security and infrastructure engineering support for a Software as a Service (SaaS) FinTech platform, managing endpoint security, vulnerability scanning and access control
- Maintained compliance with ISO 27001 controls, supporting internal audits and risk assessments
- Automated routine security and infrastructure tasks using PowerShell, reducing manual effort and improving operational consistency
- Supported identity and access management, including Active Directory and Azure AD administration, group policy and account lifecycle management

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led CrowdStrike Falcon EDR deployment and NG-SIEM onboarding across an 8,000-user estate, achieving full endpoint visibility and reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) by over 40%
- Designed and implemented automated SOAR playbooks for phishing, malware and credential-compromise alerts, cutting analyst handling time by approximately 60% on high-volume use cases
- Overhauled Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access framework, enforcing MFA for all privileged accounts and eliminating legacy authentication protocols organisation-wide
- Directed UAL's response to two significant security incidents, containing both within four hours using NIST 800-61 procedures and preventing further lateral movement
- Achieved and maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification for UAL, mapping controls to CIS Controls and ISO 27001 and remediating all identified gaps within agreed timescales
- Delivered a security awareness programme reaching 8,000 staff and students, reducing phishing click-through rates by 35% over 12 months

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)

- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London / UK)